

Figure 1: REST

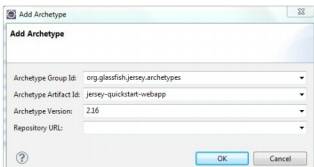


Figure 2: Archetype

Tomcat server, where the REST services will be deployed. Click on the link <https://tomcat.apache.org/download-70.cgi> to download it. In my case, it was 64-bit Windows Zip. Install the Tomcat server, integrate it to Eclipse and then start it.

Install Postman, which comes as a Chrome plugin. Click on *Settings* in the Chrome browser and go to *Extensions*. Scroll down and click *Get more extensions*. Search for *Postman* in the *Search* tab and add it to Chrome.

Now, let's start coding. In the Maven project, you will find *MyResource.java* that has the *getIt()* method which returns 'Got it!' by default, as shown in Figure 3. This Java file has three annotations named *@Path*, *@Get* and *@Produces*. The *@Path* annotation identifies the URI path template to which the resource responds, the *@Get* annotation is a request method designator and corresponds to the HTTP method, and the *@Produces* annotation is used to describe the output which can be text, JSON or XML. Right-click on the project and run it on the server. This will display a page in the browser with the link <http://localhost:8080/REST/>, as shown in Figure 4. Upon clicking the *Jersey Resource* button you will be redirected to <http://localhost:8080/REST/webapi/myresource> where you will see 'Got It!' as output. The reason behind this is that *web.xml* has the servlet mapping as */webapi*. The above URL can also be accessed through Postman to verify the output. In Postman, you can paste the URL, select the request type as *Get* and click the *Send* button. This will return 'Got It!' as the output.

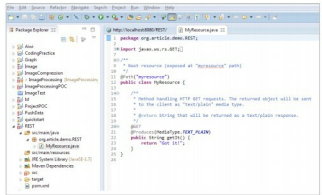


Figure 3: Default resource

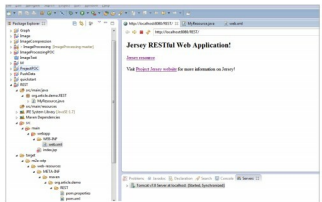


Figure 4: Default Web Page

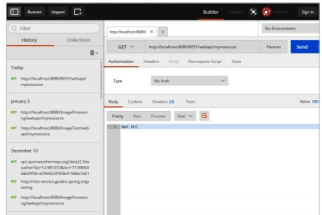


Figure 5: Postman

We can conclude that in order to access the resources from different portals, we need Web services, and one of the most widely used is REST Web services. Its security features, like user authentication and header checks, are of particular importance. 

By: Ashish Kumar Sinha

The author is a software engineer based in Bengaluru. A software enthusiast by heart, he is passionate about using open source technology and sharing it with the world. He can be reached at ashi.sinha.87@gmail.com. Twitter handle: [@sinha_tweet](https://twitter.com/sinha_tweet)